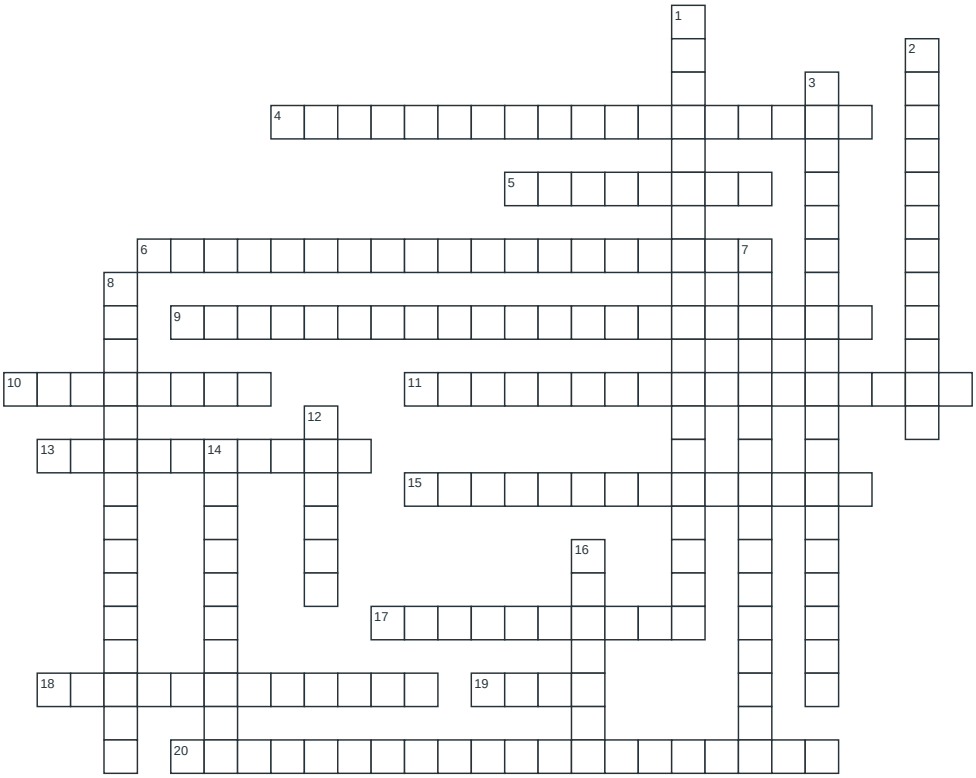
Evolution and Natural Selection Crossword

Hard | 20 clues | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Use the clues to complete the grid. Omit spaces, punctuation, and hyphens.



ACROSS

4. Inherited differences among individuals in a population.
5. Change in DNA that can introduce heritable variation.
6. A change in inherited population characteristics across generations
9. Barriers that limit gene exchange between populations.
10. Movement of alleles between populations
11. Environmental factor that affects reproductive success.
13. Evolutionary process in which populations become separate species
15. Shared ancestry inferred from similarities among organisms.
17. Members of one species living in the same area at the same time.
18. Random change in allele frequencies, strongest in small populations
19. DNA sequence that contributes to a functional product.

ACROSS (continued)

20. Inherited ability of some bacteria to survive exposure to an antibiotic.

DOWN

1. Process that involves humans choosing organisms with desired traits to reproduce
2. Collection of preserved remains and traces documenting past life.
3. Feature with a similar underlying organization inherited from a common ancestor.
7. Process in which heritable traits affecting reproduction change in frequency
8. Proportion of a population’s gene copies represented by an allele.
12. Preserved remains or traces of past life
14. A heritable feature that improves success in a particular environment
16. Relative contribution of an organism’s offspring to later generations.

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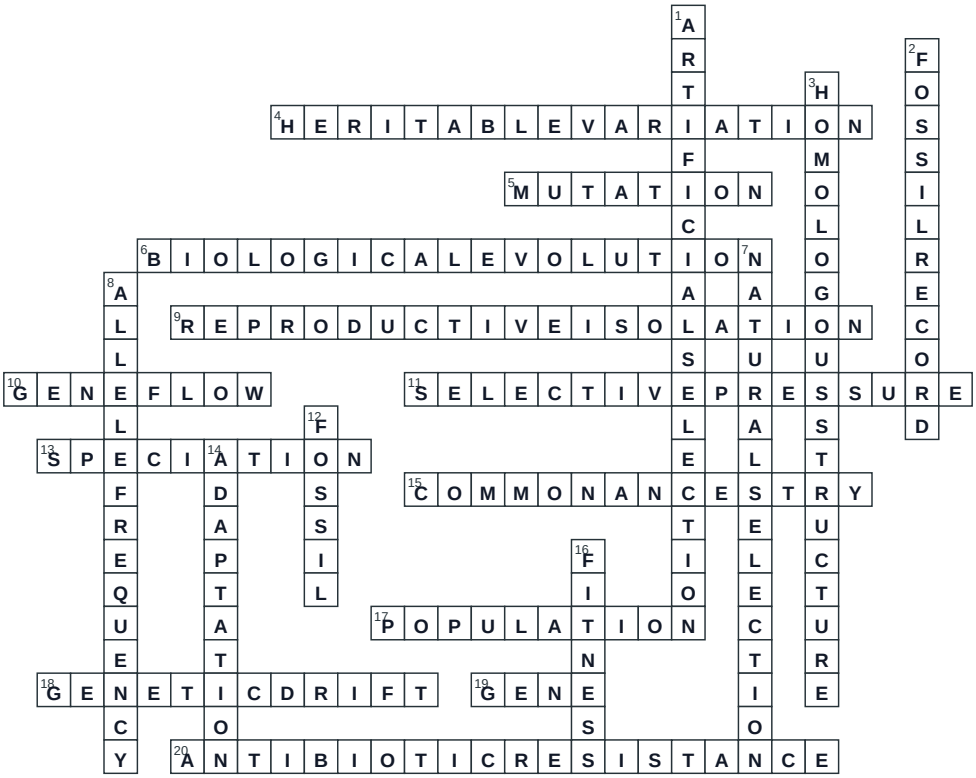
Hard | 20 clues | Teacher Answer Key

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Completed grid and numbered answers. Spaces and punctuation are omitted in the grid.



ACROSS

4. Heritable variation
5. Mutation
6. Biological Evolution
9. Reproductive isolation
10. Gene Flow
11. Selective pressure
13. Speciation
15. Common ancestry
17. Population
18. Genetic Drift
19. Gene

ACROSS (continued)

20. Antibiotic resistance

DOWN

1. Artificial Selection
2. Fossil record
3. Homologous structure
7. Natural Selection
8. Allele frequency
12. Fossil
14. Adaptation
16. Fitness

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